

AN OVERVIEW OF STUDY IN JAPAN

Japan and India have been culturally long-standing friends since the introduction of Buddhism to Japan in ancient age. In 2007, both countries celebrated Japan-India friendship year to commemorate for an anniversary of Japan-India cultural agreement. We have been working to strengthen cultural, academic and people to people exchange.

Although there are approximately 120,000 foreign students currently enrolled in Japanese Universities, the number of those from India is around 500 which is low compared to that of neighboring countries in southern Asia. This figure is also very nominal compared to the Indian students who go for studies in USA, UK, Canada and upcoming study destinations like Australia. Recently, the Japanese government has made plans to promote and raise the figure of foreign students in Japan to 300,000 by around 2020. We expect the most of them will be occupied by Indian Students.

Universities in Japan rank as number two in the world share in the number of scientific papers and place number four in the world in the number of citations – which is to say, several Japanese Universities are conducting research at the world's top level. Furthermore, the Japanese government has been undertaking prioritized support for the formation of education and research bases of the highest level in the world. The greatest appeal of studying in Japan is its academic environment where one can study state-of-the-art technology and acquire the knowledge that enabled Japan's phenomenal post-war economic growth. Japanese universities and other institutes of higher education offer course studies or research programs of virtually any field.

In Japan, higher education starts upon completion of 12 years of education. There are 5 types of higher educational institutions where international students can be admitted to, which are (1) College of Technology (2) specialized training colleges (3) Junior Colleges (4) Universities and (5) Graduate schools. The higher educational institutes are categorized as national, local, public or private. Currently, the total number of all national, local, private and Universities is about 750. About 80% have graduate schools and some of them have research facilities attached.

At present the Japanese government offers various scholarships for Indian students. The research scholarships selection procedure is carried out in cooperation with Ministry of Human Resource Development, India and the



advertisement for the same is published in all the leading newspapers of India.

http://www.in.embjapan.go.jp/Education/japanese_government_scholarships.html

Following are the names of websites where you can get information about other information related to study in Japan:

<http://www.studyjapan.go.jp/en/> (This is a Japanese Government's website for international students. It contains information about all the Universities, Colleges and courses offered, Student exchange program scholarships etc.)

<http://www.mosai.org.in/> (Mombusho Scholars Association of India (MOSAI) specializes in promoting educational, research, and academic contacts between India and Japan. MOSAI activities and services include promotion of academic and educational links between Indian and Japanese institutions and encouragement of higher studies in Japan and learning of Japanese Language. It also operates an Education Counseling Cell recognized by Japan Students Service Organization (JASSO) to provide information and give advice on opportunities available for higher studies in Japan)

http://www.jasso.go.jp/index_e.html (JASSO offers support to international students exchange programs, providing the honors scholarships for privately financed international students, collecting and disseminating information on study abroad)

MOSAI and JASSO conduct "Japan Education fair" to disseminate information about the opportunities for higher studies in Japan, focusing on the courses available, scholarship schemes of Japanese Government and other agencies for Indian students. Representative from prominent Japanese Universities, JASSO and Embassy of Japan will put up booths to provide personal guidance and counseling.

The exhibition will be held in New Delhi on October 30, 2008 from 11 am to 5pm at Sadbhava Auditorium, Daulat Ram College, Delhi University. Another exhibition will be held in Pune on November 1, 2008 from 11 am to 5pm at Garware College, Karve Road, Pune.

Source Embassy of Japan



Yamagata University

URL: <http://www.yamagata-u.ac.jp/index.html>

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